

UNIDCOM RIMS — Researcher Portal

What was built, how it works, what it changes

André Berloga · backend and business logic

18 September 2026

UNIDCOM / IADE

Portal <https://berlogabob.github.io/Unidcom-IADE/> · Public site <https://berlogabob.github.io/unidcom-site/>

What was built

The database stopped being a staging area and became the institutional record. Every write now goes through one reviewed path, and every one of them is audited.

WHEN	WHAT SHIPPED
W1-W4 August	ORCID sign-in, profile validation and output approval as two audited state machines; admin review queue; institutional PDF generated from live data; CI gating every deploy.
P0-P14 early Sep	Carmela's design system, five navigation surfaces reduced to one — and a security pass: anon revoked from the whole schema, where 153 researcher emails had been readable without signing in.
Phase C 8 Sep	Rui's 14 August notes applied. Nothing deleted: everything retired hides behind one v2 flag and still compiles in CI.
Phase D 10–11 Sep	Rui's v1.0 specification — 48 requirements, 19 gaps — specified, built and deployed inside two days. 17 PRs, all CI-green; 4 additive database changes, nothing renamed.

How it works

Researcher

signs in with their ORCID iD

registry gate: the iD must already be on file

Researcher portal

Flutter web, reads live under RLS

proposals, never direct writes

Supabase

the source of truth — 34 tables, 59 RLS policies

`sync.py`, nightly 04:00 UTC, field allowlist

Public website

Hugo static site, regenerated from the database

Approval is the gate, not a job.

Anonymous visitors see approved rows and nothing else. Publishing is a database policy that cannot silently fall behind, and Approve and Publish are now two separate admin actions.

Three privacy dimensions, deliberately different.

RLS decides which **rows**. Grants decide which **tables**. The sync allowlist decides which **fields** ever leave the database — RLS has no column dimension, which is exactly how the emails leaked.

Researchers hold no write grant.

Own work is recorded through a `security definer` RPC that forces `pending`; profile edits are staged as suggestions for an administrator to accept.

Where it stands, in numbers

AUTOMATED TESTS

269

all green today; 0 analyzer issues

OUTPUTS ON THE SITE

365

every one approved and published

RESEARCHER PROFILES

185

26 hold an ORCID iD

AUDITED CHANGES

609

who changed what, and when

Phase D, 10 → 11 September — the specification’s own measures:

MEASURE	BEFORE	AFTER
Researcher sidebar	25 leaves, 8 of them placeholders	5 items, 0 placeholders
Pages for profile / outputs	6 and 5	1 and 1
Filters on own outputs	2	8, with 5 views and 3 groupings
Researcher writes to people	direct, from an Edit dialog	0 — every edit is a proposal
Website state	approval meant publication	a separate, auditable column
flutter test	199	267 on the day, 269 today

What it changes

For the researcher

One sign-in with the ORCID iD they already have. One profile page and one outputs page instead of eleven. Corrections are proposed in place and go to a queue — no email, no form, no waiting to find out whether it landed. Their own work is added through a guided DOI-first wizard that refuses obvious duplicates.

For the administrator

A single review queue for profiles, outputs and proposed edits, each decision recorded against a person. Approve and Publish are separate, so a correction can be taken off the website without unapproving the record. Duplicate people can be merged. The institutional publication report is a 24-page PDF generated from live data, not assembled by hand.

For the institution

One source of truth that the public site is generated from, so the website cannot drift from the record. Nothing unapproved is reachable by an anonymous visitor. Every change is attributable. New entity types — projects, funding, PhD students — inherit the same approval gate by adopting one column and one policy; there is no second machine to build.

Open, and honestly so

LIVE

The portal and the public website are deployed and in use. Phase D's v1.0 scope is on the deployed portal in full.

BLOCKED

The pilot cohort has not been named. Everything downstream of that list is built and verified — this is the only blocker that is not engineering.

DATA

26 of 185 profiles hold an ORCID iD. A researcher whose iD is not on file cannot sign in at all. The fix is an administrator pass over the list, not code.

RISK

Backups cover 9 of 27 tables, and the restore script cascades into 18 it cannot put back. A restore has never been rehearsed. Highest remaining technical risk.

RISK

Bus factor of one — a single person holds Supabase, GitHub, the ORCID developer app and DNS.

TO DO

Live click-throughs of the proposal flows (≈30 min) and three wording decisions from Rui.